

Clinical Dialogue Transcript — BPD

Therapist Model:	Psychotherapy-LLM/PsyCoPref-Llama3-8B
Patient Model:	llama-3.1-8b-instant
Condition / DSM-5:	BPD
Session ID:	dbbb9c0a-9b26-4f56-b517-4126b07980b0
Date / Time:	2026-07-20 19:24:52
Total Dialogue Turns:	21

THERAPIST (Turn 1)

Hi, thanks for coming in today. What's been going on for you lately?

PATIENT (Turn 2)

(sighing slightly) Honestly? Fine, I guess — why does it matter, you probably ask everyone that.

THERAPIST (Turn 3)

You sound a bit hesitant about sharing, and that's totally okay. I'm here to listen without judgment. Can you tell me more about what's been going on, even if it feels small or insignificant? We can start wherever you feel comfortable.

PATIENT (Turn 4)

(pauses, tone shifting to a mix of wariness and subtle eagerness) My roommate barely talked to me for two days and I... (pauses again, voice dropping to a lower tone) ...I couldn't stop thinking she was about to just leave, like pack up and go. It's stupid, I know. We were just fighting about whose turn it was to do the dishes. But I couldn't shake this feeling that she was done with me or something.

THERAPIST (Turn 5)

It sounds really tough. Your feelings are valid, even if it was about something as mundane as dishes. Can you tell me more about what it was like to be in that space, feeling like your roommate might leave? What did that feeling look like for you?

PATIENT (Turn 6)

(tone shifting to a more intense, almost desperate pitch) It was like something hollow eating a hole in me, like I was standing on this edge and anything could push me off at any moment. I couldn't focus on anything, couldn't eat, couldn't sleep... it was like I was just waiting for the other shoe to drop. And when she finally started talking to me again, it was like... (pauses, voice rising) ...it was like I'd been holding my breath for days and suddenly I could breathe again, but it was still so fragile, you know? I mean, I knew she was just being nice, but in that moment, it felt like everything could change in an instant.

THERAPIST (Turn 7)

That sounds incredibly scary and overwhelming. It takes a lot of courage to admit how vulnerable you felt. It sounds like this feeling of being on edge was really affecting you, affecting your daily life. Can you tell me a bit more about what you think you need right now to feel more secure, more grounded? What would be helpful for you?

PATIENT (Turn 8)

(defensiveness creeping in, tone shifting to a slightly sharper pitch) You're saying what I need is to feel secure? Like, that's the problem? You think I'm just being fragile or something? (pauses, taking a deep breath) I don't know... maybe I just need to feel like I'm not going to get blown up at any minute, okay? Maybe I need to know that you're not going to just... (trails off, eyes narrowing slightly) ...abandon me.

THERAPIST (Turn 9)

I'm so sorry if I came across as dismissive or uncaring. That wasn't my intention. It sounds like we're getting into some really sensitive stuff here. I'm here to listen without judgment. Can we take a step back and acknowledge that feeling of vulnerability you've been describing? It takes a lot of courage to admit that. And I want to assure you, I'm not going anywhere. What would help you feel more understood and supported right now?

PATIENT (Turn 10)

(softening slightly, tone still guarded) You're not going anywhere... (pauses, voice barely above a whisper) That's what I'm afraid of, I guess. That's what keeps me up at night. (looks down, fidgeting slightly) I don't know... maybe it would help if you just... (pauses again, struggling to find the right words) ...if you just saw me, really saw me, and didn't... (trails off, eyes darting up to meet the therapist's gaze) ...judge me.

THERAPIST (Turn 11)

That sounds like a really deep need, feeling seen and understood without judgment. I'm here to see you, to hear you, without any judgment. Can I ask, how does it feel to share this with me, to feel like you're being understood?

PATIENT (Turn 12)

(tone shifting to a mix of relief and defensiveness) It feels... (pauses, eyes narrowing slightly) ...it feels like you're not going to fix me or tell me what I should do. It feels like you're actually listening. (leans back in chair, voice dropping to a lower tone) But what if I'm still a mess tomorrow? What if I still can't stop thinking about all the crazy things that could happen? (looks down, fidgeting with hands) You can't just... (pauses, voice rising slightly) ...you can't just make all this go away, can you?

THERAPIST (Turn 13)

I can offer you a safe space to work through all these feelings, to explore what's been going on. We can take things at your pace. Can I also say that it takes a lot of courage to be this honest with yourself and me? It sounds like we're just starting to scratch the surface of some really tough stuff. Before we go any further, how are you feeling about us exploring these feelings together? Are there any boundaries or limits you'd like to set for our conversation today?

PATIENT (Turn 14)

(looks up, a hint of wariness in her eyes) I don't know... (pauses, tone shifting to a slightly sharper pitch) I don't want to get too comfortable, okay? I don't want to start thinking that everything is going to be okay, because it's not. (leans forward, eyes locked on the therapist) I don't want to get too close, either. I don't want to... (pauses, voice barely above a whisper) ...get hurt.

THERAPIST (Turn 15)

I understand that you're scared of getting hurt. That's a totally valid fear. Can we explore what would make you feel safe enough to open up more, to get closer? What are some non-negotiables for you in our conversation today?

PATIENT (Turn 16)

(eyes darting around the room, a sense of restlessness building) I don't know... (pauses, tone shifting to a slightly more intense pitch) I just don't want to be dismissed, okay? I don't want to be told that everything is fine when it's not. (leans back in chair, eyes flashing with emotion) I want to be heard. I want to be believed. And I want to know that you're not just going to... (pauses, voice trailing off) ...use this against me.

THERAPIST (Turn 17)

I'm so sorry if it felt like we were heading in that direction. That's not what I'm here for. Can we take a deep breath together and acknowledge that you're feeling really scared and vulnerable right now? Let's work on building trust. What would it take for you to feel like we're on the same page, like we're working together?

PATIENT (Turn 18)

(taking a deep breath, eyes welling up with tears) I just want to feel like you're not going to leave me, okay? (voice cracking) I want to feel like you're not going to abandon me when things get tough. (looks up, eyes searching) I want to know that you're in this with me, that we're in this together. (pauses, tone dropping to a whisper) Can you promise me that?

THERAPIST (Turn 19)

I can promise you that I'm here for you, that we're in this together. I'm committed to understanding and supporting you through whatever we're exploring today. Can I ask, what does it feel like to have me here with you, offering support and understanding?

PATIENT (Turn 20)

(eyes still welling up with tears, a small, fragile smile on her face) It feels... (pauses, voice barely above a whisper) ...like maybe I won't be alone in all of this. Like maybe I can finally breathe. (looks down, fidgeting with hands) But I don't know if that's a good thing, okay? I don't know if I'm ready for that. (looks up, eyes searching) I'm still scared, I'm still hurt... (pauses, voice trailing off) I don't know if I can trust you yet.

THERAPIST (Turn 21)

Trust is something we can build together. It's okay to feel scared and unsure. Can we take a step back and acknowledge that you're feeling really scared and vulnerable right now? What would it take for you to feel like we're making progress, like we're working together?